COMP396 Weekly Meeting Minutes
(Week 9)

Date & Time: Thursday, April 16th, 2026, 17:00–19:00

Location: Harold Cohen Library, Upper Ground Floor, Group Study Table 1

Note Taker: Zhao Saria

Attendees: Zhang Olivia, Zhao Saria, Xue Ella, Wong Haw

Note: This meeting marks our reconvening after a three-week interval encompassing the Easter holiday. The primary focus is the editing and structural refinement of our Final Report.

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1. Agenda

- Review the progress of the first draft of the Final Report completed during the Easter break.
- Analyze the updated Part 3 performance results and incorporate supervisor feedback.
- Address critical report issues regarding word count, academic tone, and formatting constraints.
- Allocate final revision tasks leading up to the submission.

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2. Discussion & Decisions

2.1. Review of Easter Break Progress

During the holiday, we successfully transitioned from individual task blocks to a cohesive first draft. Each member provided a progress update on their assigned sections:

- **Section 01 (Strategy Selection - ZO):** Finalized the overview of the 70/30 portfolio architecture and the specific logic for the five sub-strategy types (Breakout, Above_MA, Z-Score, Bollinger, and RSI) applied across the ten series.
- **Section 02 (Rationale - WH & XE):** Completed chapters 2.1, 2.2, 2.4, and 2.5, which detail the statistical characteristics of the Part 2 dataset (e.g., high skewness in Series 1 and 6) and provide the rationale for the 70/30 weighting and equal-weight distribution within groups (WH); Finalized chapters 2.3 and 2.6, focusing on the justification for specific strategy variants (e.g., Above_MA vs. MACD) and the technical execution logic, including the 95% cash buffer and the overspend_guard mechanism (XE).
- **Section 03 (Performance Analysis - ZS):** Completed the initial evaluation of backtest results against the Part 2 benchmark (21.4% yield and 2.72 True PD Ratio) and drafted potential strategy enhancements such as trend consistency filters for mean-reversion components.
    - ZS also provided ongoing technical guidance and data synchronization for all sections.

2.2. Part 3 Performance and Feedback

We reviewed the newly available Part 3 performance data and feedback:

- **Yield Improvement:** The overall strategy yield in Part 3 has increased by approximately **50%** compared to the Part 2 results, validating the robustness of our core logic.
- **Supervisor Guidance:** Recent feedback suggests we consider filtering out weaker series and adopting a more selective allocation across different analytical tools to further enhance stability. ZS will integrate these considerations into the final revision of Section 03.

2.3. Structural and Formatting Challenges

We identified several critical issues that must be addressed before the final deadline:

- **Word Count Management:** The current draft significantly exceeds the 10,000-word limit. We must align the content with the required **2:3:2 ratio** across the three sections, necessitating substantial cutting and condensing.

- **Academic Tone:** The entire document requires a rigorous proofreading phase to ensure consistent academic English and professional terminology throughout.
- **Page Limit:** To comply with the **50-page limit**, we discussed moving several charts and data tables to an Appendix. ZS will email the supervisor to confirm whether this approach is acceptable within the module requirements.

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3. Task Allocation

ID	Task Description	Owner	Due Date
H1	**Content Reduction:** Condense Section 1 and Section 2 to fit the 2:3:2 word count ratio while maintaining core analytical depth.	ZO WH XE	Apr. 22
H2	**Section 3 Revision:** Integrate Part 3 performance reflections and supervisor suggestions (filtering weak series) into Section 3.	ZS	Apr. 22
H3	**Proofreading & Language Review:** Perform a comprehensive linguistic audit to ensure scholarly rigour in English writing.	All members	Apr. 22
H4	**Supervisor Follow-up:** Email the supervisor regarding the 50-page limit and the feasibility of utilizing an Appendix for charts.	ZS	Apr. 22

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4. Next Meeting Arrangement

- **Date & Time:** Thursday, April 23rd, 2026, 15:00–19:00
- **Location:** Harold Cohen Library, Upper Ground Floor, Group Study Table
- **Key Agenda:**
  - Review the finalized content and formatting based on supervisor feedback.
  - Collaborative brainstorming for the "Results Reflection" portion of Section 3.
  - Final check of the integrated Final Report before submission.